



Giggle hat

This boonie hat, worn by Australian forces in Vietnam, was intended to protect the wearer in hot and humid climates. Officially called "hats utility, jungle green," such hats were nicknamed giggle hats (as well as "hats ridiculous-for-the-use-of") by troops due to their appearance.

ROK Forces

The Republic of Korea (South Korea) provided considerable support to its US ally, in return for aid commitments to South Korea. About 300,000 ROK troops served in South Vietnam, 5,000 of whom were killed. The ROK was the third largest force to combat North Vietnamese infiltration and the Viet Cong insurgency. They conducted search-and-clear operations, usually in battalion-sized units, and excelled at setting ambushes and discovering weapons caches. In their careful sweeps of Vietnamese villages, ROK troops earned a reputation for ruthlessness. Their actions led to accusations of war crimes in several villages where hundreds of civilians were killed.